

 RELOCATION GUIDE

Nelson Tasman

Whakatū

A relocation guide for healthcare professionals and their families. The work, the neighbourhoods, the money and the weekends in Nelson Tasman.

Three national parks. The sunniest city in the country.

Nelson Tasman sits at the top of the South Island, wrapped around a sheltered bay, with more sunshine than anywhere else in New Zealand. It is the region people picture when they imagine moving here, and all of that is true. Housing takes more planning than in most regions, and we will help you get it right.

~110,000

people across Nelson
and Tasman

~2,400 hrs

of sunshine a year

3

national parks within
reach

~10 min

a typical commute

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Guides describe places, not employers. Hospitals are described rather than named, and salaries, visas and registration rules change, so we confirm the detail with you directly.

Why clinicians choose Nelson Tasman

Warm, coastal, artistic and wrapped in national parks. Nelson sells itself, so the most useful thing we can add is a clear plan for housing.

Nelson is a city of around fifty-five thousand at the head of Tasman Bay, with the Tasman District spreading west through Richmond, Māpua and Motueka to Golden Bay beyond the hill. The geography is extraordinarily generous: a warm, sheltered coastline on one side, mountains and beech forest on the other, and orchards and vineyards on the plains between.

Abel Tasman, Kahurangi and Nelson Lakes are all within a comfortable drive. No other city in New Zealand can say that. Nelson also has a real arts and craft community, a proper food and craft-beer culture, and a base hospital ten minutes from home.

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Three national parks within two hours isn't a brochure line. It's the local routine.



Small golden bays near Kaiteriteri, an hour from Nelson

WHAT YOU GAIN

The best sunshine in the country

Around 2,400 hours a year. It shapes how you live, what grows and why so many people are here.

Weekends that need no argument

Bucket-list coastline an hour away is an ordinary Sunday.

A creative city with a rich cultural life

Potters, glass artists, jewellers and painters, and a social life that goes well beyond sport.

GOOD TO KNOW

Housing

Nelson is a popular place to live, so housing costs more than in most cities its size.

Richmond and the Waimea plain, twenty minutes out, are where the numbers ease.

Distance

Christchurch is five to six hours by road or a short flight, the Wellington ferry leaves from Picton two hours away, and long-haul connects through a main centre.

Tertiary referrals

The most complex work, such as neurosurgery and cardiothoracics, is referred to Christchurch or Wellington.



Calm, clear water and a kayak: a classic summer weekend



Long beach walks with the children, any season

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Weighing up your options?

Keen to buy within a couple of years? Southland, Palmerston North or Waikato make it quicker. A tertiary hospital and a bigger city in the South Island? Christchurch. Sunshine and coast in the North Island? Hawke's Bay. A large, established diaspora community? Auckland or Wellington. We are happy to compare any of them with you.

A sunny bay sheltered by mountains

Mountains take the weather before it arrives. That single fact explains the sunshine, the orchards, the vineyards and why so many people want to live here.

Nelson city curls around the eastern end of Tasman Bay, tucked between the hills and the sea, with Tahunanui beach and the Boulder Bank on its seaward side. Twenty minutes south-west, Richmond sits on the flat Waimea plain: the region's growth area and, for many, its practical centre.

From Richmond the district runs west: Māpua on its inlet, Motueka among the orchards, and Kaiteriteri's golden sand at the edge of Abel Tasman. Beyond, the Tākaka Hill climbs into Golden Bay, Mohua, a separate world with its own famously independent community. Inland, the land rises into Kahurangi and Nelson Lakes.

Summer

DEC – FEB

Hot, dry and brilliant, around 22–26°C on the coast. In dry years, keep an eye on local water restrictions.

Autumn

MAR – MAY

Settled and golden, around 17–22°C. Harvest season, and the parks are quieter.

Winter

JUN – AUG

Mild on the coast at around 12–14°C; frosty on the Waimea plain, with proper snow in the alpine parks.

Spring

SEP – NOV

Blossom, then warm, around 15–20°C.



Inland, the land rises into Nelson Lakes and Kahurangi: beech forest and alpine water

Good to know

- ✓ Nelson takes the national sunshine title most years. The ranges strip the prevailing weather of its rain.
- ✓ Older villas are full of charm; ask about insulation and check the Healthy Homes compliance statement.
- ✓ The Waimea plain is intensively horticultural, and summer water restrictions are common in dry years, which is worth knowing if you plan a garden.
- ✓ The Tākaka Hill is the only road to Golden Bay and closes occasionally in bad weather, so check conditions before a trip over the hill.

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Words you'll hear

Whakatū is Nelson in te reo Māori. Te Tau Ihu is the top of the South Island, the prow of Māui's canoe. Mohua is Golden Bay; "the Hill" is the Tākaka Hill; Tahuna is Tahunanui; the Māitai is the river through Nelson, with its swimming holes.

Healthcare in Nelson Tasman

A base hospital in a sunny, very liveable city, serving a district that stretches from Golden Bay to the Marlborough Sounds.

Public hospital and specialist services across the top of the South Island are delivered by Health New Zealand I Te Whatu Ora as a single district with two hospital sites. The base hospital in Nelson carries acute medicine and surgery, an emergency department, intensive care, maternity, paediatrics, imaging and outpatients. A smaller hospital in Blenheim, an hour and forty-five minutes over the hills, serves Marlborough.

Around them sit community and district services, primary care, iwi and Māori health providers, aged residential care, and rural services reaching into Golden Bay and Murchison. Complex and highly specialised work goes to Christchurch, five to six hours by road or a short flight, and to Wellington for some services.



Murchison

~1 HR 30

An inland community, and one of the rural services the district reaches.



Blenheim

~1 HR 45

The district's second hospital site. Some roles involve travel between the two.



Golden Bay

~2 HRS

Over the Tākaka Hill, a close-knit rural community where access and retrieval planning are part of the work.



Christchurch

~5½ HRS, OR A SHORT FLIGHT

Where complex and highly specialised work is referred.

CAPABLE GENERALISTS

Real breadth

As the region's main centre, the hospital gives you a wide caseload and more decisions carried by you.

CASELOAD

An older population

Nelson attracts retirees in significant numbers: age-related medicine, orthopaedics, oncology and chronic disease.

CONCENTRATED IN SUMMER

Seasonal and outdoor injury

Horticulture, forestry, tramping and water sports across three national parks.

INTERNATIONAL CLINICIANS

A warm welcome

The service is genuinely open to international clinicians, and teams value the skills and experience you bring.

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Working with te ao Māori

Te Tau Ihu is the rohe of eight iwi, a more layered landscape than most regions. Iwi and Māori health providers are active partners in care, particularly in the rural districts and Golden Bay. Expect karakia, te reo on the ward and whānau in decisions. Nobody expects you to arrive fluent; a genuine willingness to learn is what matters.

What to ask at interview

- ☐ Which site, and is there cross-site working? Ask before you choose a suburb.
- ☐ What is the on-call or rostered-hours pattern, and how is it paid under the collective agreement?
- ☐ What gets referred to Christchurch or Wellington in my specialty, and how much of the pathway do I keep?
- ☐ Is there rural or Golden Bay outreach, and how does it work when the hill road closes?
- ☐ Is there relocation support, and any help with housing? It is well worth asking early here.

City, plain or village: choosing your base

Nelson city is lovely and in demand; Richmond and the Tasman District are just as lovely and considerably better value. Because commutes are short in every direction, going further out costs you very little time.

~10 MIN · CHARACTER

The Wood & central Nelson

Villas and cottages within walking distance of the cathedral, the shops and the Māitai. Desirable, walkable and much sought after.

VIEWS OVER THE BAY

Britannia Heights & Port Hills

Some of the region's best addresses, with sweeping views over the bay. Homes here are sought after and come up less often.

THE BEACH SUBURB

Tahunanui

The city's main swimming beach and a mixed, friendly community. Great value compared with the hills.

THE MIDDLE GROUND

Stoke & Nelson South

Good-value family housing, well served by schools and shops, and handy for the hospital.

~20 MIN · THE LEVER

Richmond

Flat, with its own shops and schools. Newer, warmer and better value, and closer to the hospital than parts of Nelson itself.

25–30 MIN · VILLAGES

Hope, Brightwater & Wakefield

Village schools, strong communities, more land for the money, and among the best value in the region.

~30 MIN · THE INLET

Māpua & Ruby Bay

A wharf, cafés, an arts community and coastal living. Much loved, and in demand.

45 MIN – 1 HR 30

Motueka & Golden Bay

Motueka is a real town at the gateway to Abel Tasman. Golden Bay is a world of its own, better suited to living and working locally than to a Nelson commute.

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Going further out here costs minutes, not hours, which is why the plain, not the city, is where many clinical families end up.



Hillside housing on the edge of Nelson



Nelson's heritage streets and character housing



Queen's Gardens, parkland in the middle of the city

Three things to check before you sign

- ☐ Model Richmond properly. It is the biggest financial lever in the region, and it costs you almost no time.
- ☐ Insulation and ventilation. Older villas are charming, so check how warm they are and ask for the Healthy Homes compliance statement.
- ☐ The school zone, at the exact address. Popular schools are zoned and enrolment is by address.

Most clinicians we move here rent for six to twelve months before buying, a smart move in a popular market. It also tells you whether you are a city person, a plain person or a village person before you commit.



Sunny evenings in the garden: worth looking for a north-facing section

Easy commutes, and well connected by air

Short, flat commutes and one of the country's better cycle networks. Leaving the region usually means a short flight, and Nelson Airport is ten minutes from the city.

Ten to twenty minutes to work from most of Nelson, Stoke or Richmond, with mild congestion on the Nelson to Richmond corridor at either end of the day. That is genuinely the whole traffic story, and parking at the hospital and in town is straightforward.

The Great Taste Trail is one of New Zealand's Great Rides and unusually practical: a mostly flat network linking Nelson, Richmond, Māpua, Motueka and Wakefield along coast, estuary and orchard. Because it connects real places, a number of clinicians commute on it by bike or e-bike year-round.

ELECTRIC BUSES

The eBus network

Linking Nelson, Stoke, Richmond, Wakefield and Motueka. Useful on the main corridors, quieter in the evenings, and less suited to shift rosters.

YES

Do you need a car?

Possibly only one per household if you cycle and live centrally, and a car makes the parks and beaches easy to reach.

~10 MIN FROM THE CITY

Nelson Airport

Well connected, with frequent flights to Auckland, Wellington and Christchurch. Allow for the occasional fog or wind delay.

~2 HRS TO PICTON

The Picton ferry

Then the crossing to Wellington. The route if you are taking a car north.

JOURNEY	TYPICAL TIME
Nelson → Richmond	20 min
Nelson → Māpua or Wakefield	30 min
Nelson → Motueka	45 min
Nelson → Kaiteriteri	1 hr
Nelson → Tākaka or Nelson Lakes	1 hr 30

JOURNEY	TYPICAL TIME
Nelson → Blenheim	1 hr 45
Nelson → Westport	~3 hr
Nelson → Christchurch	5–6 hr, or 1 hr flying



Off-road trails make cycling an easy everyday habit

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Travelling further afield

There is no passenger rail in the region, so flying is the easy option. Long-haul connects via Auckland, Wellington or Christchurch: allow a comfortable half-day at each end for the extra leg.

Plan for housing, and the rest falls into place

Nelson is a popular place to live, so housing costs more than in most cities its size. The good news is that the region gives you real choices.

For thirty years, people from the rest of New Zealand have chosen the sunniest, most beautiful small city in the country: retirees, lifestyle buyers and families, all sharing a finite amount of flat land between the hills and the sea. That demand is why a little planning ahead pays off.

Clinical pay is national, so you arrive on the same salary as in Palmerston North or Invercargill, into a more expensive market, with no regional loading to close the gap. What you are buying is sunshine and three national parks. That is well worth having; plan the housing and you will enjoy it.

~1.3×

Nelson city rent
against a Richmond or
Wakefield baseline

~20%

a month less, twenty
minutes out
over a year, worth more
than two months' rent

20–25 min

Richmond to the hospital

Local costs to plan for

- ✓ The extra flight leg. Every long-haul trip starts with a domestic hop; over a few trips home a year it adds up.
- ✓ Water restrictions in dry summers on the Waimea plain. An easy adjustment, and worth knowing if you love gardening.
- ✓ Warm homes. Paying a little more rent for a warm, well-insulated home is usually cheaper overall.
- ✓ The outdoor habit. Bikes, kayaks, boots and trips into three national parks. It is why you came, and it belongs in the budget.

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Why there are no prices here

A figure true when a page is written is misleading a year later. Use Tenancy Services market rent data and [realestate.co.nz](https://www.realestate.co.nz) to compare Nelson, Stoke, Richmond and Motueka side by side, and do it early.



Many of the best weekends cost very little: a tent, a lake and a long summer evening

IN SHORT

- ✓ You will live well here and rent comfortably.
- ✓ Buying in central Nelson or the hills on one income takes planning; Richmond and the plain are more within reach.
- ✓ The answer most clinicians reach is Richmond or the Waimea plain: twenty minutes out, better value, and a warmer house.
- ✓ Run the numbers before you fall in love with a villa.



SOPHIE'S INSIGHTS

What I tell people about Nelson Tasman

Nelson is the region that needs no selling, and the one where I spend the most time helping people plan their housing. The life is exactly what people imagine: sunshine, beaches, the parks on your doorstep.

My advice is always the same. Look seriously at Richmond, rent for a year before you buy anything, and ask which hospital site your role sits at before you choose where to live. Plan the housing well and it is one of the easiest places in the country to be content.

Sophie Careem

Founder & Director, Ethicare Resourcing



Time together outdoors: the reason most families tell us they came

Food, craft beer and the arts

Nelson has two things a city of this size rarely has: a serious craft-beer culture and a genuine community of working artists. Both come from decades of people choosing to live here and then making something.

Almost all of New Zealand's hops are grown on the Waimea plain, which is why Nelson became the centre of the country's craft brewing, with more breweries per head than anywhere else in New Zealand. The region also grows excellent aromatic wine, with cellar doors through the Moutere hills and out towards Māpua.

The arts community is real rather than a brochure line. Potters, glass artists, jewellers, painters and weavers have been drawn here since the 1960s by cheap land and good light. There are working studios throughout the region, the Suter art gallery in the city, and the World of WearableArt began here.

SATURDAY MORNING

The Nelson Market

The region's fixture, as strong on pottery, glass, wood and textiles as on produce.

HARDY & TRAFALGAR STREETS

Central Nelson

Restaurants, wine bars, cafés and breweries: a lively, walkable dining scene.

WORTH THE DRIVE

Māpua & Motueka

A long lunch on the Māpua wharf; good cafés and an alternative streak in Motueka.

THROUGH THE SEASON

Orchard gates

Apples, pears, berries, kiwifruit and olives, sold cheaply because there is so much of it.

The rhythm of the year



Summer is festive. Abel Tasman, Kaiteriteri and the campgrounds buzz from Boxing Day to late January, and locals love February onwards.



Harvest runs through autumn: apples, hops and grapes, and a seasonal workforce arriving with them.



Winter is mild and peaceful, and the region is all yours again.



Joining in is easy. Tramping and cycling clubs, sailing, studios and classes; turning up is genuinely enough.

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Worth planning for

There are Asian and Indian grocers, with a narrower range than a main centre, so ask us if a particular cuisine matters to your family. For big shopping trips and major touring acts, Wellington and Christchurch are a short flight away.



Fresh, local produce: market shopping is a weekend ritual for many



Green-lipped mussels, farmed in the waters at the top of the South Island

Beaches, lakes and national parks

Golden beaches an hour north, alpine lakes ninety minutes south, and one of the great wilderness tracks starting over the hill.



Kaiteriteri, the southern gateway to Abel Tasman, about an hour from Nelson

A typical Nelson weekend

- ✓ Saturday morning at the Nelson Market for produce, coffee and local craft, then a swim or a picnic at Tahunanui.
- ✓ Mountain biking straight out of town, or a bush walk up the Grampians or to the Centre of New Zealand.
- ✓ Club sport, sailing and kayaking on the bay, and the Māitai swimming holes on a hot evening.
- ✓ A ride on the Great Taste Trail to Māpua for lunch on the wharf, with the children on their own bikes or in a trailer.
- ✓ A water taxi into Abel Tasman for a day of walking, swimming and golden sand.
- ✓ Festivals, gallery openings and markets through the year, from the arts festival to summer concerts.

Abel Tasman is the country's smallest national park and possibly its most loved: granite headlands, golden sand, clear water and a coast track running its length. The Coast Track is a Great Walk of three to five days,

but the clever local move is the water taxi: boat out, walk a section, boat back. Book ahead in summer, and go in autumn if you can.

OVER THE HILL

Kahurangi & the Heaphy

Vast, wild and wonderfully uncrowded. The Heaphy Track runs from Golden Bay to the West Coast and is mountain-bikeable in winter.

TOP OF THE ISLAND

Wharariki & Farewell Spit

Wind-carved arches, dunes and seal pups, and a twenty-six-kilometre sandspit of international importance for birds.

GOLDEN BAY

Te Waikoropupū Springs

Some of the clearest freshwater ever measured. A wāhi tapu, viewed from boardwalks.

~90 MIN SOUTH

Nelson Lakes

Rotoiti and Rotoroa, beech forest to the water's edge, and the Angelus Hut circuit on the ridge above.

FROM THE CITY

Dun Mountain Trail

Mountain biking straight out of town on New Zealand's first railway line.

AFTER WORK

In the city

The Māitai swimming holes, the Centre of New Zealand walk, the Grampians and Tahunanui beach.



On the Abel Tasman coast, an hour from home

Easy trips from Nelson Tasman

Beyond the three national parks on your doorstep, the top of the South Island opens out: wine country and the Sounds to the east, the wild West Coast to the south-west, and Wellington a short flight away.

An hour and three-quarters east, Marlborough is the country's largest wine region, with cellar doors around Blenheim and the Marlborough Sounds beyond: sheltered bays, the Queen Charlotte Track and boat trips from Picton. From Picton the ferries cross to Wellington in about three and a half hours, or you can fly from Nelson in well under an hour.

South-west, the road follows the Buller Gorge to Westport and the West Coast, with the Paparoa Track and the Pancake Rocks at Punakaiki. Further south, Hanmer Springs offers thermal pools and alpine walks, and Kaikōura's whales and dolphins sit on the coast road to Christchurch.

For snow, there is a small ski area near St Arnaud at Nelson Lakes, Rainbow, whose seasons depend on the snowfall, so check it is operating before you go. The larger ski fields are in Canterbury, a long weekend away.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Tahunanui Beach	about 10 min	Nelson's own swimming beach: sand, shallow water, playgrounds and summer lifeguards.
Kaiteriteri & Abel Tasman	~1 hr	Golden sand, clear water and water taxis into the national park.
Rainbow Ski Area, near St Arnaud	~1 hr 45	A small ski area above Nelson Lakes; seasons vary with snowfall, so check before you go. Larger fields are in Canterbury, ~4–5 hrs.
Christchurch	~5–6 hrs · ~1 hr flight	The South Island's largest city, its tertiary hospital and international airport.
Nelson Airport	about 10 min	Frequent flights to Auckland, Wellington and Christchurch; long-haul connects through them.
Wellington	~35 min flight · or ferry from Picton	The capital for a weekend: Te Papa, Zealandia and the waterfront.
Blenheim & Marlborough wine country	~1 hr 45	Cellar doors, long lunches and cycling between vineyards.

GETTING TO	ROUGHLY	WHY GO
Punakaiki & the West Coast	~3 hrs 30	Pancake Rocks, the Paparoa Track and a wild, beautiful coastline.

~1 HR 45

Marlborough wine country

Cellar doors and long lunches around Blenheim, with flat roads made for a vineyard cycle.

~2 HRS TO PICTON

Queen Charlotte Track

Walk or ride sections of this Sounds track, with boats carrying your bags between bays.

~35 MIN FLIGHT

Wellington

Museums, theatre and shopping in the capital, an easy weekend away by air or ferry.

~3 HRS 30

Punakaiki & the Paparoa

The Pancake Rocks and blowholes, and the Paparoa Track, one of New Zealand's Great Walks.

~3 HRS 30

Hanmer Springs

Hot pools, forest walks and mountain biking in an alpine village, a favourite family weekend.

~4 HRS

Kaikōura

Whale watching, dolphins, seals and crayfish on the coast road to Christchurch.



Queen Charlotte Sound in the Marlborough Sounds, about two hours east of Nelson



Oriental Bay in Wellington, a short flight from Nelson

Sunshine, safety and space

Is it a good place with children? Very much so: sunshine, safety, beaches, space, sport and the outdoors everywhere, at a pace that leaves time for family.

Children usually start school at five; primary runs Year 1 to Year 8 (often with intermediate schools for Years 7 and 8) and secondary Year 9 to Year 13, across four terms a year.

Most children go to free state schools. Alongside them are state-integrated schools, many of them Catholic or Christian, which follow the national curriculum and charge modest attendance dues, and a few independent schools. Kura kaupapa Māori and bilingual units teach in te reo Māori.

Long-established secondary schools include Nelson College and Nelson College for Girls in the city, Nayland College in Stoke and Waimea College in Richmond, with smaller town and village schools across the district.

Choosing a school

- ☐ Check the enrolment zone at the exact address before you sign a lease. Popular state schools run enrolment schemes, and living in zone guarantees a place.
- ☐ Read the school's report from the Education Review Office at ero.govt.nz; ERO reviews every school and early childhood service.
- ☐ Visit, or ask for a video call. Principals are used to families arriving from overseas.
- ☐ Ask about support for children new to New Zealand, including English language help.



Rabbit Island, a short drive from Richmond: long beach, pine forest, an easy family day

What children tend to love here

- ✓ Tahunanui beach, the city's own swimming beach.
- ✓ The flat, family-friendly Great Taste Trail by bike.
- ✓ Natureland, the small wildlife park by Tahunanui beach, and Founders Heritage Park.
- ✓ Libraries in Nelson, Stoke and Richmond, with holiday programmes and storytimes.
- ✓ The Māitai swimming holes on a summer evening.
- ✓ A water taxi into Abel Tasman and a walk back along the coast.
- ✓ Riverside Pool in Nelson and the aquatic centre in Richmond for lessons and rainy days.

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Finding your community

The health workforce has welcomed overseas clinicians for years, so you will find other international colleagues on your team, and a long-established horticultural workforce brings people from across the Pacific and beyond. If a large diaspora community is high on your list, Auckland or Wellington may suit; if a friendly, welcoming community appeals, Nelson could be a great choice, and we will help you find your people.



Bush tracks and waterfalls, an easy outing with children



Pīwakawaka, the fantail: children soon learn to spot native birds

20 HOURS ECE

Early childhood

Up to 20 hours a week of funded early childhood education for three to five-year-olds at participating kindergartens and centres.

TERTIARY IN NELSON

NMIT

The regional polytechnic, Nelson Marlborough Institute of Technology, offers degrees and diplomas including nursing. For university, most students go to Christchurch, Wellington or Dunedin.



A beach that people fly across the world for is your ordinary Sunday.

Your Nelson Tasman address book

Nelson Tasman has a well-organised multicultural scene for its size, coordinated by Multicultural Nelson Tasman on Waimea Road. Its directory lists more than forty community groups, including Malayalee, Indian, Filipino, Sri Lankan, Nepalese, Chin and Bhutanese communities, alongside a Pasifika trust, a mosque in Stoke and a Thai Buddhist temple in Richmond. Specialist groceries are thinner than in a main centre.

COUNCILS

Nelson City Council

Local services, libraries, pools, parks and community programmes

nelson.govt.nz

Tasman District Council

Richmond, Motueka, Golden Bay and the rural districts

tasman.govt.nz

GETTING TO KNOW THE PLACE

Nelson Tasman NZ

The region's official visitor site: the parks, the trails, the makers and what's on

nelsontasman.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks and conditions for Abel Tasman, Kahurangi and Nelson Lakes

doc.govt.nz

GETTING IN AND OUT

Nelson Airport

Flights, parking and arrivals information

nelsonairport.co.nz

Interislander

The Cook Strait ferry from Picton, two hours' drive away

interislander.co.nz

COMMUNITY & CULTURAL ASSOCIATIONS

Multicultural Nelson Tasman

The region's multicultural hub: community and cultural navigators, a Motueka coordinator, a youth group (MYNT), workshops, the annual Multicultural Festival, and a directory of every local community group. 544 Waimea Road

03 539 0030 multiculturalnt.co.nz

Nelson Malayalee Community

Kerala families in Nelson Tasman. Contact them through the Multicultural Nelson Tasman directory

multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Nelson Indian Cultural Society

Indian cultural events and festivals; listed in the Multicultural Nelson Tasman directory

multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Nelson-Tasman Filipino Community Inc

Filipino association with cultural dance groups and community events

multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Sri Lankan Community, Nelson

Sri Lankan families' network; contact through the Multicultural Nelson Tasman directory

multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Nelson Nepalese Community

Nepalese festivals and community support

multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Bhutanese Community of Nelson

Incorporated society led by Bhutanese families resettled in Nelson

bhutanesesocietyofnelson.weebly.com

Chin Community of Nelson

Represents roughly 800 Chin people from Myanmar living in Nelson Tasman

multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

IndoNelson

Umbrella group for Indonesians in Nelson, offering settling-in help and cultural events

indonelson.wixsite.com/indonelson

NZ Chinese Association, Nelson & Marlborough Branch

Chinese community and cultural celebrations

multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Korean Association of Nelson Tasman

Korean community network

multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Nelson Tasman Pasifika Community Trust

Health, education, social services and community development for around 1,500 Pasifika people; 53 Collingwood Street

0508 727 4325 nelsonpasifika.org.nz

English Language Partners Nelson

English classes, home tutoring and workplace English, many free for residents; 83C Hardy Street, with classrooms in Nelson South and Stoke

03 539 4848 englishlanguage.org.nz/nelson

NMIT English language courses

NZ Certificates in English Language (Levels 3 to 5) and short Study English courses

nmit.ac.nz/study/study-areas/english-language

Wellby Talking Cafés

Informal conversation get-togethers, good for practising English and meeting locals

wellby.org.nz/talking-cafes

Citizens Advice Bureau Nelson Tasman

Free help with tenancy, employment and settling-in questions

cab.org.nz/location/cab-nelson-tasman

Tasman District Council: New to Tasman

The council's newcomer page linking settlement, English, library and school resources

tasman.govt.nz/my-community/new-to-tasman

FACEBOOK & ONLINE GROUPS

Multicultural Nelson Tasman (Facebook)

Festival dates, workshops and community-group notices

facebook.com/MulticulturalNT

Nelson Tasman Dutch (Facebook group)

Dutch community group for Nelson Tasman

facebook.com/groups/NTDutch

Nelson Tasman Pasifika (Facebook)

Pasifika community news and events

facebook.com/NelsonTasmanPasifika

PLACES OF WORSHIP

St John Paul II Catholic Parish

Seven churches: St Mary's (18 Manuka St, Nelson), St Francis (Stoke), Our Lady of Perpetual Help (35 William St, Richmond), St Peter Chanel (423 High St, Motueka), plus Tākaka, Wakefield and Waimea West

027 337 4622

cadw.nz/parish/st-john-paul-ii-parish

Christ Church Cathedral, Nelson

Anglican cathedral at the top of Trafalgar Street

nelsoncathedral.nz

All Saints Anglican, Nelson

Anglican parish in Nelson city

allsaints.co.nz

Richmond Anglican

Holy Trinity and St Alban's churches in Richmond

richmondanglican.church

Motueka Anglican Parish

St Thomas', St Barnabas' and St James' churches

motuekaanglican.org.nz

Victory Church

Community church in Victory, Nelson South; part of the Anglican diocese

victorychurch.org.nz

Nelson Islamic Centre

Mosque at 435 Nayland Road, Stoke. The Nelson Whakatū Muslim Association and the Ahmadiyya Muslim Community also meet locally
multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Thai Buddhist Temple (Wat), Richmond

Thai temple at 377 Lower Queen Street, Richmond, open to all
03 544 5906

multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Chandrakirti Meditation Centre

Tibetan Buddhist centre with teachings and retreats
03 543 2021 chandrakirti.co.nz

Nelson Sanatan Ramayan Mandli

Fiji-Indian Hindu community group. There's no Hindu temple; a local Hindu priest performs pujas and ceremonies, contactable through Multicultural Nelson Tasman
multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Chin Glory Evangelical Church

Chin-language evangelical congregation
multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Sikh and Jewish communities

There's no gurdwara or synagogue in Nelson; the nearest are in Christchurch or Wellington. The NZ Jewish Council can connect you
nzjc.org.nz

HALAL, KOSHER & INTERNATIONAL GROCERIES

Ebonlon Asia Food Market

Asian supermarket at 281 Hardy Street, central Nelson
03 548 2188 yellow.co.nz/nelson/grocery

Bin Inn Nelson

Bulk foods, spices, flours and pulses at 16 Bridge Street
yellow.co.nz/nelson-region/supermarkets

Halal meat

There's no dedicated halal butcher; ask at the Nelson Islamic Centre where members currently buy
multiculturalnt.co.nz/community-directory

Kosher food

Nothing kosher is sold locally; families order from Wellington or Auckland suppliers
nzjc.org.nz

Asian Grocer (online)

National online Asian grocer delivering to Nelson Tasman
asiangrocer.co.nz

SA Shop NZ (online)

South African groceries delivered nationwide
sashopnz.co.nz

UK Foods (online)

British groceries delivered nationwide
ukfoods.co.nz

SUPERMARKETS & MARKETS

Woolworths Nelson

Full-range supermarket at Paru Paru Road and Halifax Street; Woolworths also has stores in Richmond and Motueka
woolworths.co.nz

New World Nelson

Supermarket at Vanguard and Gloucester Streets; New World also has stores in Richmond, Stoke and Motueka
newworld.co.nz

PAK'nSAVE Richmond

The region's discount supermarket, in Richmond
paknsave.co.nz

FreshChoice Nelson City

Locally owned supermarket at 69 Collingwood Street in the city centre
freshchoice.co.nz

Four Square (Atawhai, Victory)

Neighbourhood supermarkets in Atawhai and Nelson South
foursquare.co.nz

Nelson Market

Every Saturday, 8am to 1pm, in Montgomery Square, rain or shine: produce, food, crafts and artisans, running for 40+ years

03 546 6454 nelsonmarket.co.nz

Motueka and Māpua markets

Smaller weekend markets worth the trip; check Nelson Tasman's events listings for days

nelsontasman.nz/events

SCHOOLS, UNIFORMS & FAMILIES

Education Counts: Nelson Tasman schools

Find schools and enrolment zones for any address

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Early learning finder

Kindergartens, daycares and playcentres across Nelson Tasman

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-an-els

School uniforms

Most schools sell uniforms through their own uniform shop, and PTAs often run second-hand sales. Ask at enrolment

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Nelson Public Libraries

Elma Turner Library (27 Halifax St) plus Stoke and Nightingale (Tāhunanui) branches: storytimes, holiday programmes and free Wi-Fi

nelsonpubliclibraries.co.nz

Tasman Libraries

Libraries in Richmond, Motueka, Tākaka and Murchison

tasmanlibraries.govt.nz

Plunket

Free Well Child checks and parent groups; PlunketLine is 24/7

0800 933 922 plunket.org.nz

Playcentre

Parent-led early childhood sessions across Nelson Tasman

playcentre.org.nz

Multicultural Youth Nelson Tasman (MYNT)

Youth group for 13 to 21-year-olds, with its own Sunday radio show on Fresh FM

multiculturalint.co.nz/mynt-multicultural-nelson-tasman-youth

HOUSING & AREAS

Trade Me Property: Nelson Tasman rentals

The main rental listings site for Nelson, Stoke, Richmond and Motueka

trademe.co.nz/a/property/residential/rent/nelson-tasman

Tenancy Services market rent tool

Check fair rents by suburb before you apply; Nelson's market is tight

tenancy.govt.nz/rent-bond-and-bills/market-rent

Nelson City Council rates search

Rates for any Nelson address (Nelson, Stoke, Tāhunanui, Atawhai)

nelson.govt.nz/3rates/rates-search

Tasman District Council: rates and property

Rates and property information for Richmond, Motueka, Māpua and Wakefield

tasman.govt.nz/my-property/rates

Trade Me flatmates

Rooms and flatshares for your first weeks

trademe.co.nz/a/property/flatmates-wanted

GETTING AROUND

eBus

Electric buses on eight routes linking Nelson, Stoke, Richmond, Wakefield and Motueka, plus a Late Late Bus, with live tracking and route maps. The bus hub is at 41A Halifax Street

ebus.nz

Bee Card

eBus fare card for tag-on, tag-off discounted fares; Motu Move payment is also being introduced

beecard.co.nz

Nelson Airport

Ten minutes from the city, with frequent flights to Auckland, Wellington and Christchurch

nelsonairport.co.nz

InterCity

Coaches to Picton, Christchurch and the West Coast

intercity.co.nz

Interislander and Bluebridge

Cook Strait car ferries from Picton (two hours' drive) to Wellington

interislander.co.nz

NZTA driver licensing agents

Find the nearest AA or VTNZ agent for licence conversion

nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

COST OF LIVING COMPARISONS

Numbeo: Nelson

Crowd-sourced cost of living for Nelson, which you can compare with your current city

numbeo.com/cost-of-living/in/Nelson

Powerswitch

Compare electricity and broadband plans for your address

powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted budget planner

A free tool for planning your first months' budget

sorted.org.nz

Stats NZ prices

Official food price and inflation data

stats.govt.nz



Checked October 2026

Community groups, shops and pages change. If a link has moved or you know a group we should add, tell us and we will update the guide.

Numbers and websites to keep handy

The national services every newcomer uses, wherever in New Zealand you land.

EMERGENCIES & HEALTH ADVICE

Emergency services

Police, fire and ambulance, any time

111

Healthline

Free 24/7 health advice from a nurse, in any language

0800 611 116

Need to talk?

Free call or text a trained counsellor, 24/7

1737

National Poisons Centre

24/7 advice if someone may have been poisoned

0800 764 766

PlunketLine

Free 24/7 support for parents of under-fives

0800 933 922

VISAS, REGISTRATION & WORK

Immigration New Zealand

Visas, the Green List and residence pathways

immigration.govt.nz

Immigration Advisers Authority

Check an adviser is licensed before you pay

iaa.govt.nz

Responsible authorities

The registration board for every regulated health profession

health.govt.nz/regulated-health-professions

Nursing Council of New Zealand

Registration for nurses

nursingcouncil.org.nz

Medical Council of New Zealand

Registration for doctors

mcnz.org.nz

HEALTHCARE FOR YOUR FAMILY

Health New Zealand | Te Whatu Ora

How public healthcare works and who is eligible

tewhatuora.govt.nz

Healthpoint

Find a GP, pharmacy, dentist or urgent care near you

healthpoint.co.nz

ACC

Accident cover for everyone in New Zealand, including visitors

acc.co.nz

SCHOOLS & CHILDCARE

Find a school

Every school, with its enrolment zone

educationcounts.govt.nz/find-school

Education Review Office

Independent reports on schools and early learning

ero.govt.nz

Parents and whānau

How schooling, early childhood education and fees work

parents.education.govt.nz

MONEY, HOME & GETTING AROUND

Inland Revenue (IRD)

Your IRD number, tax and KiwiSaver
ird.govt.nz

Tenancy Services

Renting rules, bonds and market rents by area
tenancy.govt.nz

NZ Transport Agency

Converting your overseas driver licence
nzta.govt.nz/driver-licences

Powerswitch

Compare power companies in your area
powerswitch.org.nz

Sorted

Free, independent budgeting tools
sorted.org.nz

MPI · pets

Bringing cats and dogs into New Zealand
mpi.govt.nz/bring-send-to-nz/pets-travelling-to-nz

SETTLING IN

Citizens Advice Bureau

Free, confidential help with almost any question
0800 367 222 cab.org.nz

Ministry for Ethnic Communities

Support and connections for new migrant communities
ethniccommunities.govt.nz

Department of Conservation

Huts, tracks, campsites and Great Walks bookings
doc.govt.nz



Always check the source

Rules, fees and services change. Treat these as starting points and confirm details with the organisation. Ethicare are recruitment specialists, not licensed immigration advisers.

Six steps, and someone beside you for each one

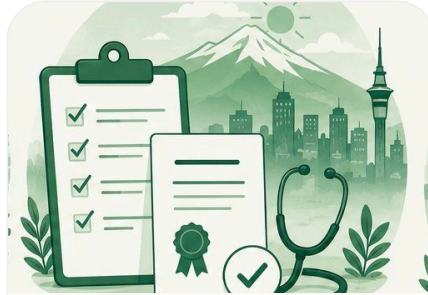
Moving country is a sequence of decisions. We take them with you in order, so you are never solving step five before step two is done.



STEP 1

Discovery call

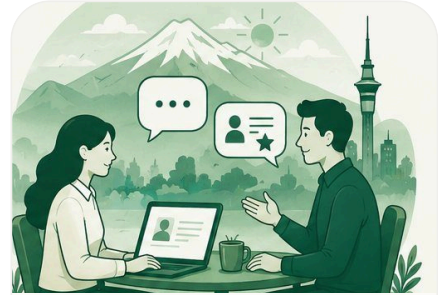
A relaxed conversation about your profession, your family and what you want from a move. No forms, no pressure.



STEP 2

Eligibility & registration

We map your route to New Zealand registration and help you gather the evidence the regulator will ask for.



STEP 3

Opportunities & interviews

Roles matched to where you want to live and how you like to work, with honest briefings before every interview.



STEP 4

Offer & decision support

We help you read the offer properly: pay step, relocation support, roster and what the team is really like.



STEP 5

Visa & relocation guidance

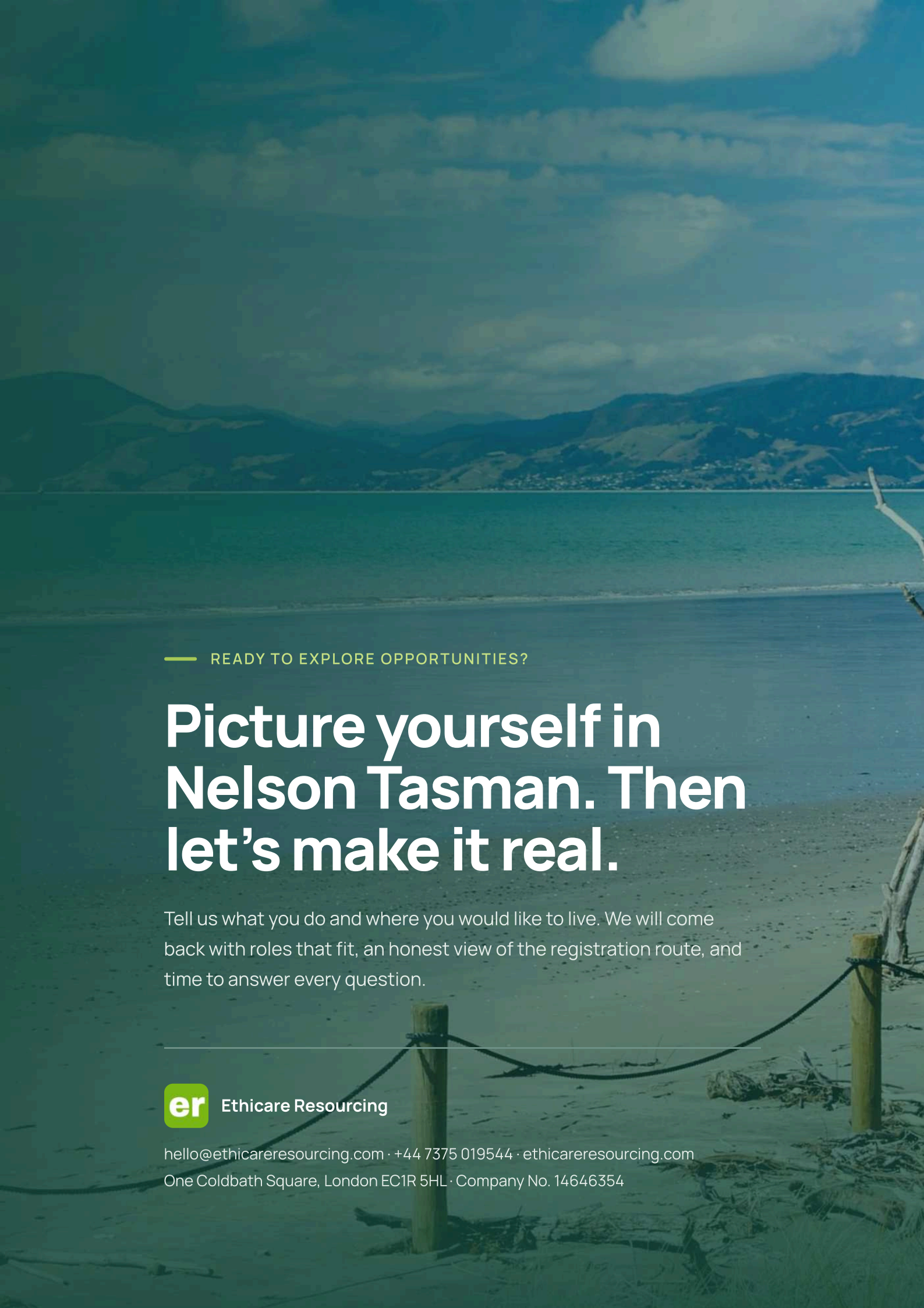
Practical guidance on visas, shipping, pets, schools and the first weeks, so nothing arrives as a surprise.



STEP 6

Settling in

We stay in touch after you land, from your first week on the ward to your first winter.



— READY TO EXPLORE OPPORTUNITIES?

Picture yourself in Nelson Tasman. Then let's make it real.

Tell us what you do and where you would like to live. We will come back with roles that fit, an honest view of the registration route, and time to answer every question.



Ethicare Resourcing

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